Ultrasound Scheduling at WHA

Women's Healthcare Associates

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Background

We have created a new role for centralized US scheduling called Ultrasound Scheduling Specialist who will work closely with our Ultrasound Scheduling Coordinators and report directly to the NWP Patient Services Supervisor

They are the scheduler for all WHA OB Ultrasounds with the exception of the OB visits that are scheduled during the NOB Workflow by PS Staff

Workflow Goals

Our goal is to always try to schedule the US with a same day in person follow up at the patient's home location with their Care Team Provider

If the priority goal is not possible, see next scheduling alternatives:

1. Schedule US and follow up visit at patient home location with another home location call group provider

2. Schedule US at a different WHA location and then a same day follow up with the patients Care Team provider or another provider at the patients' home location if Care Team provider not available. Make sure to factor in drive time for the patient

3. Schedule US at a different WHA location and then a same day Telehealth follow up with the patients Care Team provider or another provider at the patients' home location if Care Team provider not available.

4. Schedule a follow up on another day at home location. The exception is any D&V US's should be prioritized to always have a same day follow up

5. If unable to schedule any of the above, reach out to the patients Care Team providers PSR for further guidance

Ultrasound Scheduling Specialist

The role of Ultrasound Scheduling Specialist is to schedule all internal WHA OB ultrasounds with the exception of 12 – 13.6wk US's that line up with the current NOB Workflow (handled by PS Staff). This includes scheduling any subsequent follow-ups along with the ultrasound

See link to the OB scheduling workflow for more info: **Scheduling NOB Visits**

Daily Tasks

OB – Call every 4 business days after initial contact (total of 3 attempts)

High Risk or Urgent OB – Call every 2 business days after initial contact (total of 4 attempts)

Documentation

- **WHA Ultrasound Imaging Schedule Orders WKQ**
  (*See Page 5 for the USS WKQ workflow link*)

- **Patient Summary (for Chart documenting)**
  This is a great documenting tool for all information related to US scheduling. Staff (Patient Services, Advice, etc.) will also be able to access this information for (i.e. return calls) and further documentation can be added the summary as needed. **Only** USS's and USC's can create and edit the document

  > See the **Patient US Scheduling Summary** tip sheet for details on creating, documenting and viewing a Patient Summary

WHA US SCHEDULING POOL

Staff Messages, CC'd charts and other communications from PS Staff, Advice RN's or Clinicians requesting ultrasound scheduling will fall to this pool

Early D&V scans will be forwarded to this pool, which could come through as a CC'd chart or other message type

WHA Ultrasound Imaging Schedule Orders WKQ

Ultrasound orders that are placed by a provider will fall to this work queue and will be separate from the current department based Imaging Scheduling Workqueue's

Ultrasound Scheduling Specialist will monitor this WKQ daily and call patients to schedule

See the Ultrasounds section of this workflow: **Scheduling Orders/Appt Request Workqueue**

If the patient No Showed the Ultrasound and is being actively contacted by our PS Team per OB No Show Workflow, defer for 3 days and attach order as needed

- **Ultrasound Scheduling Skills (general & priority)/Five9**
  When a patient calls WHA and chooses the Scheduling Skill, they will be prompted within the skill auto attendant to choose an option for US Scheduling. The prompt will let the caller/patient know to choose this line if their WHA/NWP provider has ordered an US for them

  Auto Attendant Scripting: "*To schedule an ultrasound that your provider has ordered, Press 1. For all other needs, press 2*"

Duplicate vs Cancelling Orders

Duplicate: If you notice duplicate imaging orders are in place, send a **Staff Message** to the appropriate **Pod Pool** for order cancellation

Cancelling: For orders that need to be cancelled for reasons other than being a duplicate (Patient delivered, Transferred Care, No longer needs, etc.), start a **Telephone Encounter** including the reason for the order cancellation request and send to the appropriate **Pod Pool** so it can be kept documented in the patient chart

Calls from Patient Services

If a patient makes it to the Scheduling Skill and needs an US scheduled (other than 12 – 13.6wk) then Patient Services will warm transfer to the *Priority US Scheduling* skill. This is unless the patient is needing to schedule their OB Workup then PS staff will schedule accordingly

During Check Out: PSR's will use best judgement to determine if they should get the follow up scheduled with a provider before the US is scheduled. The Ultrasound Scheduling Specialist will do their best to match an US to the scheduled follow up, though they may need to reschedule to match with US availability

PSR's can utilize the following scripting to patients:

"We have you scheduled on ___ for a follow up with ___. Our US Scheduling team will be reaching out to you to schedule your ultrasound. Know that the follow up visit may need to be moved from its current date and/or time to accommodate scheduling the ultrasound same day."

PSR Contacts:

West - PSR HG (Ext *3997*)
South - PSR HG (Ext *1307*)
East – TA Frontline (Ext *7850*) / GW Frontline (Ext *3818*)

For a detailed Pod/PSR list, click this link: **WHA PSR Resource List**

Calls from Advice

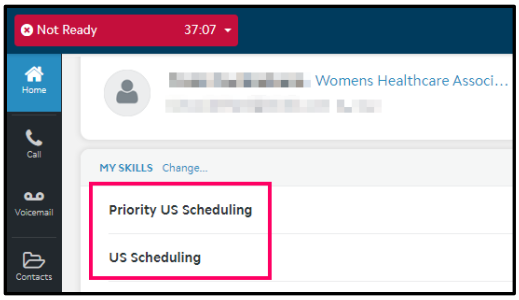
- **Routine:**

  When Advice has a patient on the phone that needs to schedule an Ultrasound along with a follow up

  > Advice will then do a warm transfer call to the *Priority US Scheduling* skill to give the scheduler(s) details about what needs to be scheduled then transfer patient

- **Urgent:**

  Advice will place the patient on hold and call the Ultrasound Scheduling Specialist to coordinate an US and follow up within appropriate time frame



Note:

If we cannot get a patient in for an US at WHA within the correct time frame then we would need to offer to schedule externally @ another facility. If US order is for Sequential NT screening, must schedule at WHA

See the Ultrasound Flexibility Scheduling workflow for more details

Scheduling Scripting

- Children @ visit scripting: "*Unfortunately, WHA kindly asks that children do not attend Ultrasound appointments at this time.*"

    > If the patient indicates they do need to bring their child(ren) to their US visit, reply using the following scripting: "*I will let our Ultrasound Coordinators know and they will follow up with you to discuss this further.*"

    > After scheduling, send a Staff Message with the subject as "*Child at visit*" then "*FYI child(ren) attending Ultrasound visit on xx/xx/xx*" to the US Coordinator team (*WHA US Coordinators Pool*)

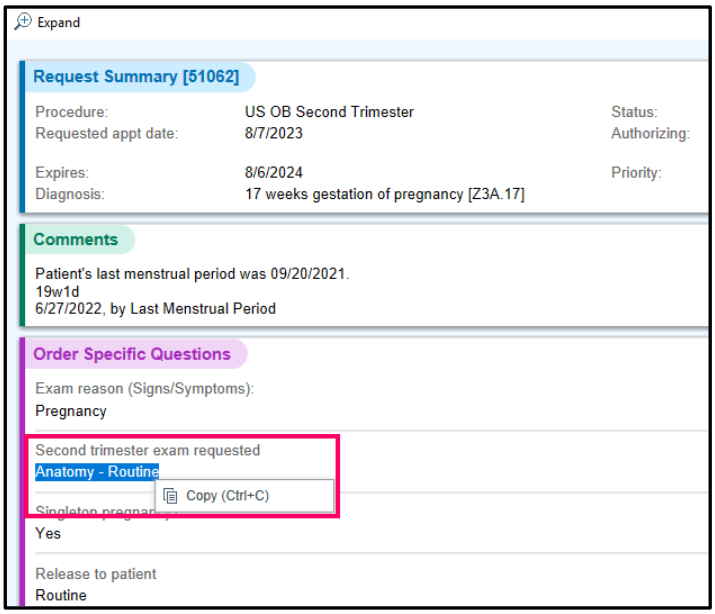
    See Visitor and Patient Guidelines document for more details

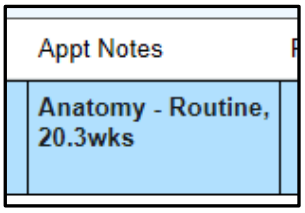
US Appointment Notes

Follow the below standards when adding US appt notes to scheduled visits:

- **OB** – GA or LMP. Add Twins/Triplets as needed (*Expand order then copy from exam requested section and paste within Appt Notes*)
- **OB 12 – 13.6wk US** – Staff attaching the US order will add the exam requested to the visit notes
- **GYN Pelvic** – No notes

OB Example:





Patient Services

Note: Schedule **GYN US's** as usual. The USS team will be scheduling all WHA OB US's with the exception of the 12 -13.6wk OB Visit/US

See link to the OB scheduling workflow for more guidance: **Scheduling NOB Visits**

Scheduling notes:

- **During Check Out:** PSR's can use their best judgement to determine if they should get the follow up scheduled with a provider before the US is scheduled. The Ultrasound Scheduling Specialist will do their best to match an US to the scheduled follow up, though they may need to reschedule to match with US availability

  Scripting suggestion for patients:

  "We have you scheduled on ___ for a follow up with ___. Our US Scheduling team will be reaching out to you to schedule your ultrasound. Know that the follow up visit may need to be moved from its current date and/or time to accommodate scheduling the ultrasound same day."

- If PSR's need to schedule in the moment (*i.e. Provider brings a patient to you for specific scheduling requests, etc.)* then it is okay schedule the US and follow up as necessary. **Send a Staff Message to the *WHA US Scheduling Pool* so the US Schedulers can double check scheduling details**

- **If we cannot get a patient in for an US at WHA within the correct time frame then we would need to offer to schedule externally @ another facility. If US order is for Sequential NT screening, must schedule at WHA**

  See the Ultrasound Flexibility Scheduling workflow for more details

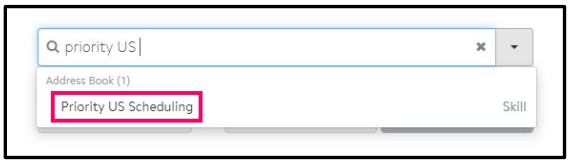
Ultrasound Scheduling Requests

There are a variety of ways that we receive requests to schedule ultrasounds.

Below are workflows for each scenario:

- **Phone**
  When a patient calls WHA and chooses the Scheduling Skill, they will be prompted within the auto attendant to choose an option for US Scheduling. The prompt will let the caller/patient know to choose the line if their provider has ordered an US for them.
  Auto Attendant Scripting: "*To schedule an ultrasound that your provider has ordered, Press 1. For all other needs, press 2.*"

  If a patient makes it through to the Scheduling Skill and needs to schedule an OB US (other than the 12-13.6wk OB visits) then warm transfer to the *Priority US Scheduling* skill



- **EH/Saturday Clinic**

  If a patient calls during Extended Hours to schedule an US we will inform the patient that someone from our US Scheduling team will be giving them a call Mon-Fri during regular business hours to schedule

  Send a **Staff Message** (marked **high priority**) to the *WHA US Scheduling Pool* with scheduling information/details to call the patient back

- **In Person/Check Out**

  At check out, staff will contact the *Priority US Scheduling* skill for guidance if the patient needs scheduling right then or if urgent
  Otherwise, send a **Staff Message** to the *WHA US Scheduling Pool*

- **CC'd Chart/ Staff Message/ Online scheduling (RS/Cancellations)**

  If a CC'd Chart/Staff Message indicating the need for OB US scheduling (other than 12 – 13.6wk OB visit) or cancellation/reschedule requests are sent to the PS Pool, forward to both the *WHA US Scheduling Pool* for scheduling and the appropriate PS Pool for follow up reminders and tracking

  > Early D&V scans (if indicated prior to 12-13.6wks) – If confirmed order is in place, forward to the *WHA US Scheduling Pool* and then reach out to Advice if needed

  > **Cancellations/Cancellation Requests:**

    Patient's **cannot** officially cancel US's but they can request to cancel, however they **can** cancel an OB check or follow up visit via MyHealth

    When you see a cancelled OB Check message you will double check to see if an US is scheduled along with it so both visits get rescheduled together

    Note: *Each cancellation or cancellation request will show up as a separate message under the in basket*

- **Epic Check Out Notes**

  - When PS staff go through to clean up the DAR at the end of the day (TH check out/No Shows, etc.), there might be check out notes found that indicate an OB US is needed to be scheduled. Check to see if orders were placed by the provider. If they are in place, no need to do anything further as the orders will fall to the WHA Ultrasound Imaging Schedule Orders WKQ that the US Schedulers will take care of

  If you notice that **NO** orders are in place, send a **Staff Message** to the *WHA US Scheduling Pool* to let them know to follow up

- **Call Backs**

  - When patients call back or to simply view OB US scheduling information documented by the Ultrasound Scheduling Specialist, you can find current notes from a Patient Summary in the Chart. See the workflow on how to view the summary **Viewing the Patient Ultrasound Scheduling Summary**

Additional Scheduling Scripting

- Children @ visit scripting: "*Unfortunately, WHA kindly asks that children do not attend Ultrasound appointments at this time.*"

    > If the patient indicates they do need to bring their child(ren) to their US visit, reply using the following scripting: "*I will let our Ultrasound Coordinators know and they will follow up with you to discuss this further.*"

    > After scheduling, send a Staff Message with the subject as "*Child at visit*" then "*FYI child(ren) attending Ultrasound visit on xx/xx/xx*" to the US Coordinator team (*WHA US Coordinators Pool*)

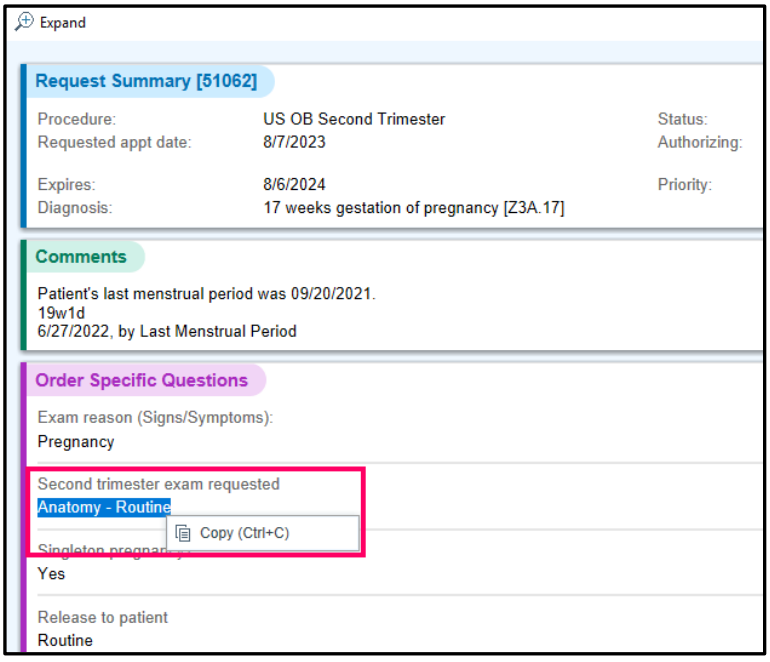
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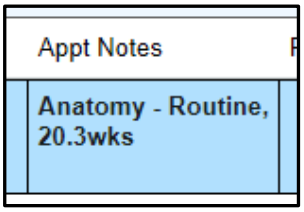
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- **OB 12 – 13.6wk US** – Staff attaching the US order will add the exam requested to the visit notes
- **GYN Pelvic** – No notes

OB Example:





Advice Nurse

- **Routine:**
    - > When Advice has a patient on the phone that needs to schedule an OB Ultrasound along with a follow up
    - > Next, Advice will do a warm transfer call to the *Priority US Scheduling* skill to give the scheduler(s) details about what needs to be scheduled then transfer patient

- **Urgent:**
    - > Advice will place the patient on hold and call the Ultrasound Scheduling Specialists to coordinate an US and follow up within appropriate time frame

